

Laptop Usage Guide

A practical guide for employees using company laptops safely, efficiently, and responsibly in an IT startup environment.

Purpose	Help employees use company laptops effectively while protecting company information, accounts, and equipment.
Audience	Employees, interns, contractors, and other authorized users of company laptops.
Scope	Daily operation, security, maintenance, connectivity, software, and incident reporting.

1. Getting Started

Before using a company laptop, make sure you know your assigned device, company account, IT support channel, and the basic rules for handling company information.

First-time setup

Sign in using the account provided by the organization. Complete required security enrollment such as device management, multi-factor authentication, antivirus/endpoint protection, and disk encryption if configured by IT. Do not disable these controls.

Workspace and handling

Keep the laptop on a stable, clean surface with adequate ventilation. Avoid blocking air vents. Handle the screen by its frame rather than pressing directly on the display. Keep liquids and food away from the keyboard and ports.

Power and charging

Use the approved charger or a compatible charger recommended by IT. Avoid damaged cables, loose connectors, or unofficial power adapters. If the laptop becomes unusually hot, swollen, or emits a burning smell, disconnect power if safe and contact IT immediately.

Golden rule: The company laptop is a business asset. Treat it as if it contains confidential company information—even when you are only browsing or working on routine tasks.

2. Daily Laptop Usage

Good daily habits improve productivity, reduce hardware problems, and make it easier for IT to support your device.

Starting work

Connect to an approved network, sign in with your company account, and allow required security and software updates to complete. Check that your collaboration, email, VPN, and other required applications are working before beginning important work.

Organize files properly

Store work documents in the company's approved cloud storage, shared drives, or project repositories. Avoid keeping the only copy of important work on the laptop's local desktop or Downloads folder. Use clear file names and appropriate project folders.

Manage applications

Install software only from approved sources and according to company policy. Do not download pirated software, unknown browser extensions, cracked applications, or tools that request unnecessary administrative privileges.

Performance and battery

Close applications you no longer need, keep the operating system updated, and restart the laptop when updates require it. If battery life suddenly drops, the fan runs constantly, or performance becomes unusually slow, report the issue instead of repeatedly forcing shutdowns.

Lock when you step away

Always lock the screen when leaving the laptop unattended, even for a short period. Use the operating system's built-in lock function rather than simply closing applications.

Useful routine

■	Connect through an approved network
■	Keep security software and OS updates enabled
■	Save work in approved company storage
■	Lock the laptop when unattended
■	Shut down/restart when required by updates
■	Report unusual hardware or security behavior

3. Laptop Security & Data Protection

A company laptop may provide access to source code, customer information, internal systems, credentials, financial data, and intellectual property. Security is therefore part of everyday laptop usage.

Protect your account

Use a strong, unique password and multi-factor authentication where required. Never share passwords or one-time authentication codes. Do not leave passwords written on paper attached to the laptop.

Phishing and suspicious messages

Be cautious with unexpected email attachments, links, login requests, urgent payment requests, and messages asking you to bypass normal procedures. Verify unusual requests through a trusted channel before acting.

Public places and travel

Avoid leaving a company laptop unattended in vehicles, cafés, meeting rooms, or public areas. When traveling, keep the laptop physically with you when practical. Use approved VPN and security controls when required by company policy.

USB devices and peripherals

Do not connect unknown USB drives or other unfamiliar devices. External storage can introduce malware or expose company data. Use only approved peripherals where company policy requires it.

Screen privacy

Be aware of people around you when working with confidential information. Avoid displaying sensitive data in public areas where it can be easily viewed or photographed.

Backups and recovery

Follow the organization's approved backup and cloud-storage process. Do not assume that every file saved locally is automatically recoverable. If important files disappear or become corrupted, stop making unnecessary changes and contact IT.

Lost or stolen laptop

Report a lost or stolen company laptop immediately through the company's IT/security process. Do not wait until the next working day. IT may be able to revoke sessions, disable access, locate the device, or remotely protect company information.

Security rule of thumb

If a laptop action could expose company data, install unknown software, bypass a security control, or give another person access to your account, stop and check with IT first.

4. Maintenance, Troubleshooting & Support

Most laptop problems can be handled safely with a few basic checks. Avoid advanced configuration changes unless your IT team instructs you to make them.

Laptop is slow or unresponsive

Close unnecessary applications and browser tabs. Check whether a system update or restart is pending. If the problem continues, record what applications were running and contact IT. Avoid downloading random “PC cleaner” or optimization tools.

Wi-Fi or internet problems

Confirm Wi-Fi is enabled and that you are connected to the correct approved network. Try disconnecting and reconnecting once. If coworkers are also affected, report it as a possible network issue. Follow company VPN instructions where applicable.

Battery or charging issue

Check the charger and power connection. If the battery drains unusually quickly, the laptop becomes extremely hot, or the battery appears physically swollen, stop using the device if necessary and contact IT or the authorized hardware support team.

Software or security warning

Do not ignore repeated antivirus, endpoint-security, certificate, or operating-system warnings. Take a screenshot of the message if company policy allows, note when it appeared, and report it to IT.

What to include in an IT ticket

Device	Laptop model and asset/tag number if available
System	Operating system and approximate version
Issue	Clear description of what is not working
Time	When the problem started
Steps	What you tried before contacting IT
Error	Exact error message or screenshot, if permitted

Never include passwords, MFA codes, private keys, recovery codes, or other secrets in an IT ticket. IT support should not need your password to troubleshoot a normal laptop issue.

End-of-day checklist

Save work to approved storage • Close sensitive documents • Lock or shut down as required • Disconnect from public networks when finished • Keep the laptop physically secure • Report incidents promptly.

Document owner: IT / Internal Support • Review periodically as company policies and device standards change